How to say "*after doing sthg*", and "*before doing sthg*"

- These two English structures looks similar, but the French equivalents look very different and **do not use a VERBing type structure**.

- BEFORE DOING STHG:

    - **AVANT DE + INFINITIVE**
      Avant de faire mes devoirs, j'ai mangé une pomme.
      Je me suis lavé les mains avant de manger une pomme.
      Avant de NOUS coucher, nous NOUS sommes brossé les dents.

- AFTER DOING STHG:

    - **APRÈS AVOIR/(s')ÊTRE + PAST PARTICIPLE**
      Après avoir fini mes devoirs, j'ai mangé une pomme.
      Après M'être lavé les mains, j'ai mangé une pomme.
      Après NOUS être brossé les dents, nous NOUS sommes couchés.

- **Note**: in both of these structures the same persons must do both actions, and the reflexive pronoun "SE" has to agree with the subject of the verb.

How to translate English verbs ending -ING

- **The present participle in French** (travaillANT, mangeANT etc) **is not used systematically to translate all English verbs ending in – ING**. It is used only in particular instances. See the next section**.**

- **Remember: a French verb can NEVER be followed by a participle**

    - ~~**Je suis MANGEANT**~~ ~~**Il m'a vu TRICHANT**~~

- **French makes no difference between** " I do" and "I am doing" – JE FAIS, "I did" and "I was doing" – JE FAISAIS, "I have done" and "I have been doing" – J'AI FAIT, or "I had done" or "I had been doing" – J'AVAIS FAIT.

- You have already learned about verbs of posture "she was sitt**ing**" – *elle était assise*, etc which use a PAST PARTICIPLE to translate the English verb in -ING**.**

- **Verbs of perception: after a** verb **of perception (seeing, hearing etc) you will use an** INFINITIVE to translate the English verb in –ING

    - *Je les ai entendus CHANTER.*

Il m'a vu JOUER au ping-pong.

The present participle

- **To form the PRESENT PARTICIPLE:**
  - Take the NOUS form of the present tense
  - Remove the ONS and replace with ANT
  - mangeANT, regardANT, finissANT

- **There are only three exceptions:**
  - **Savoir** - SACHANT
  - **Avoir** - AYANT
  - **Être** - ÉTANT

- **The present participle is INVARIABLE** and therefore never agrees**.**

- **The present participle is used:**

- **To translate IN/ON/BY/WHILE VERBING.** The ONLY preposition you will find in front of the present participle is EN. This one word translates all of the four meanings.

  - *En la voyant, il a souri*
  - *J'ai écouté la radio en faisant mes devoirs*
  - *En travaillant dur, tu réussiras à tes examens*

- **To translate the – ING verb when it happens SIMULTANEOUSLY with the action of the MAIN verb** even if no preposition is used in English**:**

  - *Elle est entrée en souriant*

- **To translate verbs of motion followed by a preposition in English (to run IN, to limp OUT, to run DOWN).** The PREPOSITION is translated by a verb in French.

  - *Elle est entrée en COURANT*
  - *Il est sorti en BOITANT*
  - *Nous sommes descendus EN COURANT*